Mariano Marcos State University
SDG 15 · Life on Land

STORYBOARD · CHAPTER 05 OF 13

05

Sustainable land management for agriculture

8 frames

15 LIFE ON LAND

THE STORY

Four channels to the farmer: radio, village training, demonstration plots and on-farm practice.

MMSU'S COMMITMENT

Take an active role in protecting and promoting sustainable use of terrestrial ecosystems, responsible land use, and biodiversity conservation.

THE FILMSTRIP · 8 FRAMES

2025



1


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8

AT A GLANCE

1,000
School-on-the-Air enrollees

46
bamboo trainees

15 → 30
onion farmers



MMSU School-on-the-Air (Eskuela iti Tangatang) season on regenerative vegetable farming, June–December 2025. (Image: MMSU)

24–25 JUN 2025 SEASON OPENING · BROADCAST JUNE–DECEMBER 2025

School-on-the-Air Brings Regenerative Vegetable Farming to 1,000 Ilocanos

1. **THE PROGRAMME**
   A new season of MMSU's School-on-the-Air (Eskuela iti Tangatang) on regenerative vegetable farming opened with 1,000 enrollees from the 22 municipalities and cities of Ilocos Norte.

2. **THE LESSONS**
   Climate-smart practices and off-season vegetable seeding, aired over DWFB Radyo Pilipinas Laoag, DWCI Radyo Adjo Piddig and DWNI Radyo Karruba Burgos.

3. **WHO LEARNED, WHO PARTNERED**
   Vegetable growers, rural improvement club members, extension workers and students; run with the Provincial Government, the Provincial Agriculturist, LGUs, ILAARRDEC and the High-Value Crops Division.

1,000	22	3
enrollees	municipalities & cities	radio stations

Source: MMSU News, "MMSU draws 1K enrollees for SOA program on sustainable vegetable farming," 26 June 2025



7th Parambak ditoy MMSU, in front of CAFSD, 14 February 2025. (Photo: MMSU STRATCOM)

14 FEB 2025 · IN FRONT OF CAFSD, BATAC

Parambak ditoy MMSU 2025 Showcases Extension Technologies for Farmers

1. **THE EVENT**
   The 7th Parambak ditoy MMSU closed the 47th Foundation Anniversary, showcasing how extension and research programmes support community development and agricultural innovation.

2. **WHO TOOK PART**
   37 exhibitors, including ATI-Ilocos learning sites, Magsasaka Siyentista, Balik-Probinsya beneficiaries and LGUs, with the Provincial Government, NGOs, farmer leaders and entrepreneurs.

3. **WHAT HAPPENED**
   Participants harvested fresh vegetables at the President's Farm, 17 new Extension partners were recognised, and the Research Directorate presented off-season tomato and shallot, Bolinao chicken, indigenous vegetables and black garlic.

37	17	47th
exhibitors	new Extension partners	Foundation Anniversary

Source: MMSU Extension Directorate, "'Parambak' caps MMSU@47 celebration," February 2025



Participants of the bamboo propagation, nursery and plantation management training, Brgy. Aglipay, Pinili, 2025. (Photo: MMSU)

2025 · BRGY. AGLIPAY, PINILI, ILOCOS NORTE

Bamboo Propagation and Plantation Management Training in Pinili

1. **THE TRAINING**
   A two-day bamboo production training by the Extension Directorate and CAFSD with Barangay Aglipay, supported by ILAARRDEC.

2. **THE SKILLS**
   Bamboo propagation, nursery establishment and plantation management for 46 farmers, local leaders and community members, who also helped establish a new bambusetum.

3. **THE EXPERTS & CHAMPIONS**
   Lectures and demonstrations by Mr. Charlie Maine Cacactin (CAFSD) and Mr. Bonne Jovie Orteza (MMSU); championed locally by Pinili's Magsasaka Siyentista Mr. Reynaldo Antalan.

46	2
participants	training days

Source: MMSU News, "Sustainable livelihood: MMSU, ILAARRDEC hold bamboo training in Pinili," 3 September 2025



Pilot vermicomposting facility of Pasuquin white onion farmers, 2025. (Photo: MMSU STRATCOM)

2025 · PASUQUIN, ILOCOS NORTE · AGRI-TECH FACILITATOR PROGRAM

Vermicast Facility Helps Pasuquin Onion Farmers Restore Degraded Soils

1. **THE FACILITY**
   White-onion farmer-leaders of the Ayat ti Pasuquin Farmer and Irrigators Association set up a pilot vermicomposting facility under the MMSU–Jollibee Group Foundation Farmers Entrepreneurship Program.

2. **HOW IT WORKS**
   African night crawlers (Eudrilus eugeniae) convert biodegradable farm waste into vermicast, an organic fertilizer that improves soil structure, stimulates microbial activity and reduces chemical inputs.

3. **WHY**
   A response to soil degradation from prolonged reliance on chemical fertilizers, which farmers linked to poor soil conditions and low seedling survival.

1
pilot facility

Source: MMSU News, “Vermicast facility established in Pasuquin as MMSU, Jollibee Group aid onion farmers,” 1 August 2025



Pre-Dispersal Training on White Onion Production, Pasuquin Municipal Hall, 12 November 2025. (Photo: MMSU STRATCOM)

12 NOV 2025 · PASUQUIN MUNICIPAL HALL

Pasuquin Onion Farmers Trained on Good Agricultural Practices

1. **THE TRAINING**
   A Pre-Dispersal Training on White Onion Production by the Municipality of Pasuquin, MMSU and the Jollibee Group Foundation for the San Juan Icas Manuel Farmers' Association.

2. **THE TOPICS**
   White onion production technology, good agricultural practices (GAP) and proper farm recording for sustainable and profitable farming.

3. **THE REACH**
   Farmer participation doubled from 15 to 30 beneficiaries with a collective production target of 200 tons for 2025; the Office of the Provincial Agriculturist supplies seeds and planting materials.

15 → 30
farmer beneficiaries

200 t
production target

Source: MMSU News, "Pasuquin onion farmers trained by MMSU and Jollibee Group Foundation," 18 November 2025



President's Farm technology demonstration of inbred and hybrid rice varieties, 28 October 2025. (Photo: MMSU)



Farmers, LGU technicians and students at the President's Farm Field Day, in front of CAFSD. (Photo: MMSU)

28 OCT 2025 · PRESIDENT'S FARM, IN FRONT OF CAFSD

President's Farm Field Day Showcases Climate-Resilient Rice Varieties

1. **THE EVENT**
   The MMSU Extension Directorate and PhilRice Batac held the President's Farm Field Day: A Technology Showcase.
2. **WHO TOOK PART**
   Farmers and farmer-leaders, agricultural technicians from Ilocos Norte LGUs, BS Agriculture students, and MMSU and PhilRice rice specialists.
3. **WHAT THEY SAW**
   Eight rice varieties under wet-season conditions: four newly released by PhilRice, two public hybrids, and two for saline and rainfed fields, e.g. NSIC Rc 686 (Salinas 39) and NSIC Rc 650 (Sahod Ulan 36).

8	4	2
rice varieties	newly released	saline / rainfed

Source: MMSU News, "MMSU President's Farm showcases 8 rice varieties," 4 November 2025



PSHS-Ilocos Region Campus students at the MMSU Technology Demonstration Farm, Sarrat, 19 September 2025. (Photo: MMSU STRATCOM)

19 SEP 2025 · TECHNOLOGY DEMONSTRATION FARM, STA. MAGDALENA, SARRAT

Science High School Students Learn Sustainable Farming at MMSU's Demonstration Farm

1. **THE VISIT**
   59 Grade 11–12 students of Philippine Science High School–Ilocos Region Campus visited during National Biotechnology Week as part of their community immersion programme.
2. **THE PROGRAMME**
   After an orientation at the ILAARRDEC One-Stop Information Shop, Extension Director Dr. Marlowe Aquino discussed biotechnology in agriculture and MMSU's hybrid off-season tomato varieties.
3. **THE LEARNING**
   Students observed sustainable farming practices on site.

59
students

Source: MMSU News, "PSHS-IRC students visit MMSU demo farm for sustainable farming practices," 3 October 2025



Kick-off meeting of the soil health management project with Griffith University and provincial agriculturists, 16 June 2025. (Photo: MMSU STRATCOM)

2025 · PROJECT SLAM 2023/146 · GRIFFITH UNIVERSITY, ACIAR, DOST-PCAARRD

MMSU Leads Soil Health Research for Rice-Based Cropping Systems

1. **THE PROGRAMME**
   MMSU is a key partner in a five-year research programme building soil knowledge and capacity for sustainable cropping systems; President Manzano pledged the university's commitment at the 24–26 Mar 2025 inception meeting in Balanga City, Bataan.

2. **MMSU'S ROLE**
   Leads the rice-based cropping systems project in Ilocos Norte, Tarlac and Bataan (Dr. Janet Villamor): nutrient management and yield-calibrated soil health indices for rice-garlic, rice-rice and rice-onion systems.

3. **THE KICK-OFF**
   16 Jun 2025 at the Center for Flexible Learning with Griffith University, the country project manager and the provincial agriculturists of three provinces, with visits to sites in Batac, Vintar and Pasuquin.

5 yrs	3	3
programme	provinces	cropping systems

Source: MMSU News, "MMSU tapped as key partner in enhancing PH cropping systems through soil health management," 31 March 2025 · MMSU News, "Griffith University, MMSU launch cropping system research in Luzon," 3 July 2025

WHERE THE STORY LANDS

Over the air to 1,000 enrollees in all 22 municipalities and cities, and in village trainings, field days and demonstration farms, MMSU carries regenerative and climate-smart farming to where farmers work.

1,000	46	15 → 30
School-on-the-Air enrollees	bamboo trainees	onion farmers

THE FRAMES

1. **School-on-the-Air Brings Regenerative Vegetable Farming t...**
   24–25 Jun 2025 season opening
2. **Parambak ditoy MMSU 2025 Showcases Extension Technologie...**
   14 Feb 2025
3. **Bamboo Propagation and Plantation Management Training in Pinili**
   2025
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   19 Sep 2025
8. **MMSU Leads Soil Health Research for Rice-Based Cropping Systems**
   2025

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